

- Formula: Observation -> Feeling -> Need -> Request
- Move: separate observable facts, feelings, needs and a clear request so difficult expression becomes less blaming and more actionable
- Minimum: When X happened, I felt Y because I need Z. Would you be willing to do A?
- Best for: conflict repair, boundary conversations, emotionally charged requests, relationship repair and needs-based communication
- Avoid when: weaponising vulnerability, pseudo-therapy, manipulative requests, urgent safety moments or situations where the other person has not consented to deep emotional processing
- Failure mode: turning the framework into polished blame, pressure, or moral superiority
- Neighbour: Validation Without Agreement - Use NVC / OFNR when the Observation -> Feeling -> Need -> Request structure is the main need; use Validation Without Agreement when that adjacent move better serves the moment.
- Neighbour: Clean Request - Use NVC / OFNR when the Observation -> Feeling -> Need -> Request structure is the main need; use Clean Request when that adjacent move better serves the moment.